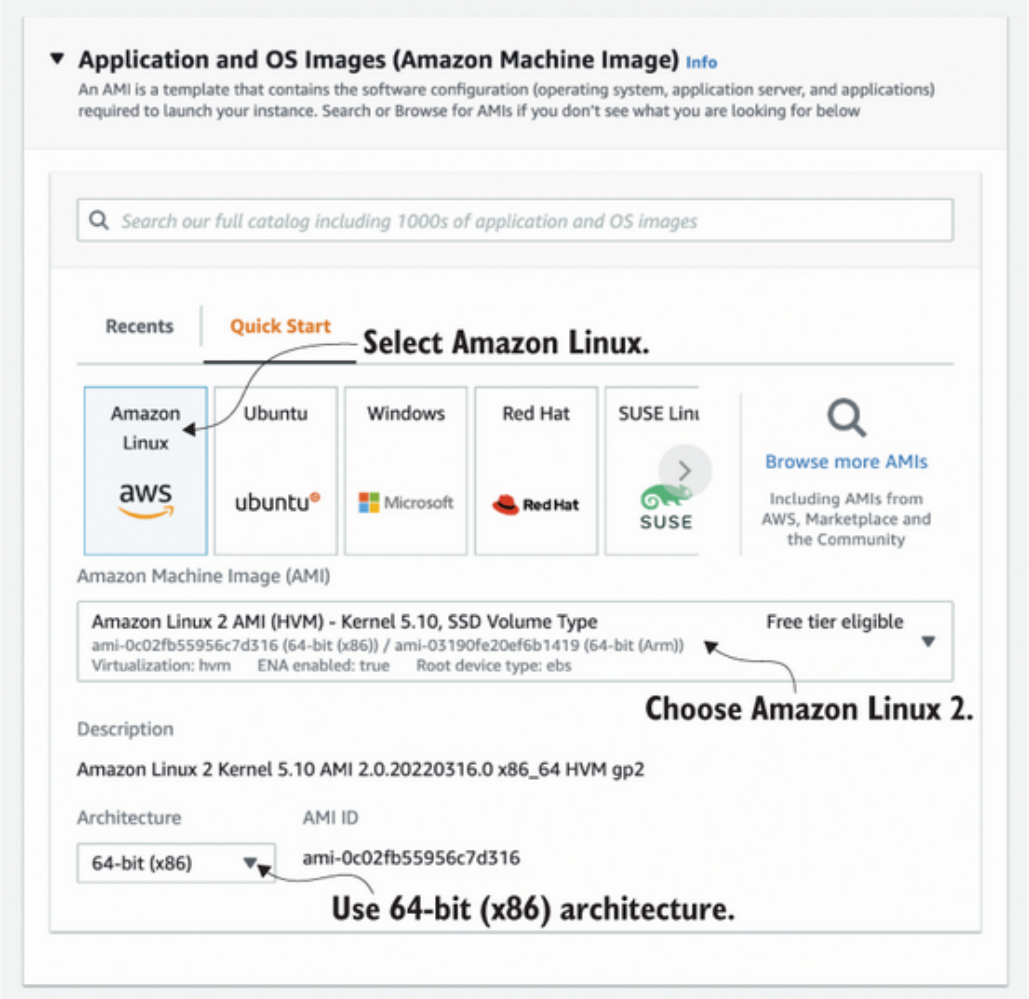


Figure 3.4 Choose the OS for your virtual machine.

The AMI is the basis for your virtual machine starts. AMIs are offered by AWS, third-party providers, and by the community. AWS offers the Amazon Linux AMI, which is based on Red Hat Enterprise Linux and optimized for use with EC2. You'll also find popular Linux distributions and AMIs with Microsoft Windows Server as well as more AMIs with preinstalled third-party software in the AWS Marketplace.

When choosing an AMI, start by thinking about the requirements of the application you want to run on the VM. Your knowledge and experience with a specific operating system are other important factors when deciding which AMI to start with. It's also important that you trust the AMI's